

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Electron Microscope

190.4

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

190.4

Manual Section Title

Electron Microscope

Version Number**Effective Date of this Version**

This is a longstanding national coverage determination. The effective date of this version has not been posted.

Ending Effective Date of this Version

12/18/2014

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

The electron microscope has been used in the examination of biopsies for years; its efficacy, and therefore its Medicare coverage, is not being questioned. However, there are less expensive methods for examining biopsies which are normally adequate. The additional expense for the electron microscope is normally warranted only when distinguishing

different types of nephritis from renal needle biopsies or when there is an uncertain diagnosis from the pathologist. When an uncertain diagnosis from the pathologists results from a less expensive method of examination and an electron microscope examination is therefore necessary, both biopsy examinations are covered. Where the additional expense for an electron microscope examination is not warranted, payment is based upon the less costly methods of examining biopsies.

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Electron Microscope - RETIRED	3	04/10/2023 - 12/18/2014	View
Electron Microscope - RETIRED	2	12/18/2014 - 12/18/2014	View
Electron Microscope	1	01/01/1966 - 12/18/2014	You are here